

A picture for the post: the image recipe and five prompts

From The Travel Advisor's AI Playbook (Empowerment AI). Free to use and share.

The same free ChatGPT account that wrote your Facebook post can make the picture for it. Free accounts get only a few images a day (the number is not published and changes with load; the banner in the app is the truth), so write the whole prompt before you press Enter. Google's free Gemini app is a good spare and is more generous.

The one rule for images

Mood and concept only. The real resort, ship, or room always gets the supplier's real photo.

Supplier photo libraries are licensed for exactly that, and they are true. An AI image is for atmosphere, season, and illustration, never for anything a client could rely on as fact.

Never: real people, supplier or cruise line logos, a specific property presented as real, maps or layouts. If an image could be mistaken for a photo of the real thing, label it ("illustration" or "AI image") or make it obviously stylized. Your host agency's and suppliers' brand rules still apply.

The recipe: five parts, one sentence each

1. **Subject:** what is in the frame, and how much of it.
2. **Setting:** where, and what time of day or year.
3. **Style:** the medium. A warm editorial travel photograph, a loose watercolor, a flat illustration, a vintage poster.
4. **Light and mood:** golden hour, soft haze, calm, quiet, a little luxurious.
5. **Format:** square for Facebook. "No text on the image." Add the text later in Canva, where you can change it on Tuesday.

Then, if you have a brand: "Colors lean navy and warm gold." And the don'ts: "No logos, no people, nothing that names a real hotel."

Editing is a conversation. After the first image, say what to change in plain words: "Make it dusk." "Take the people out." "Same scene, watercolor." You do not start over.

Five prompts to try (all invented trips)

IMG1, the picture for a hosted cruise post

Create a square image for a Facebook post about a hosted group cruise to the Western Caribbean in February. Subject: a quiet ship balcony with two chairs and a small table, coffee on the table. Setting: early morning arriving into a Caribbean port,

turquoise water, a green headland in the distance. Style: warm editorial travel photograph. Light and mood: soft sunrise light, calm, unhurried, a little luxurious. Format: square, no text on the image, no people, no logos, nothing that identifies a real cruise line or ship.

IMG2, a destination mood image (pairs with your reusable destination answer)

Create a square image. Subject: a small stone terrace with a table, two glasses of white port, and a bowl of olives. Setting: the Douro Valley in Portugal in early October, vineyard terraces stepping down to the river, a few clouds. Style: loose watercolor illustration with visible brush texture and white paper showing through at the edges. Light and mood: late afternoon, warm, quiet. Format: square, no text, no people, no logos.

IMG3, text on the image (this did not work two years ago; it mostly does now, so proof every letter)

Create a square announcement card for a travel advisor's Facebook page. Background: a soft, slightly blurred photograph of turquoise Caribbean water seen from above, no people. Centered text in a clean modern sans-serif, dark navy: the line "8 cabins left" large, and below it smaller "Western Caribbean, February 2027". Plenty of clear space around the text. No other words, no logos.

If a letter is wrong: "Fix the text so it reads exactly: 8 cabins left."

IMG4, keep one look across your page

Make another image in exactly the same watercolor style, colors, and framing as the Douro terrace image, but set in Santorini in late September: a small whitewashed terrace, a table with two coffees, the caldera and the sea beyond. Square, no text, no people, no logos.

IMG5, the edit round (say it in the same chat as IMG1)

Same image, but make it dusk instead of sunrise, add a folded blanket on one chair, and keep everything else the same.

What AI images are good for, and not

Good for: mood and atmosphere, a season or a concept, a soft background you put a headline on, illustration in a style you reuse so your page looks like one person made it.

Not for: the actual resort or ship a client is buying, real people, anything that must be accurate (distances, pools, maps), logos.